

ovate, mid-green leaves. Bears creamy-white flowers, with spreading, purplish-pink lobes and white throats, from midsummer to early fall. As the flowers age, the pink coloration deepens and extends into the flower tubes. Z9–11

P. ‘Papal Purple’ (illus. p.237). Mound-forming, semievergreen perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 14in (35cm). Has narrowly lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In summer, bears small, rather rounded, white-throated, lilac-purple flowers. Z6–9

P. ‘Pennington Gem’. Vigorous, semievergreen perennial. H to 2½ft (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has narrow, fresh green leaves. Bears sprays of tubular, pink flowers from midsummer to fall. Z9–11

P. ‘Pensham Just Jayne’ (illus. p.237). Robust, bushy, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, deep green leaves. Produces rich, deep cerise-pink flowers, with faintly white-lined, magenta throats, from early summer to fall. Z9–11

P. ‘Pensham Victoria Plum’. Robust, semievergreen perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has narrowly lance-shaped, bright green leaves. In summer, produces spikes of bright blue-purple flowers with burgundy-purple-marked, white throats. Z8–10

P. ‘Pershore Fanfare’. Vigorous, semi-evergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In summer, bears racemes of large, tubular, lavender-blue flowers, each with a white throat striped in darker purple. Z8–10

P. pinifolius illus. p.340. **‘Mersea Yellow’** is an evergreen, bushy subshrub. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 10in (25cm). Produces branched stems clothed in fine, dark green leaves. In summer, very narrow, tubular, bright deep yellow flowers open in loose, terminal spikes. (borderline) Z8–10.

‘Wisley Flame’ has bright orange-red flowers.

P. ‘Port Wine’ (illus. p.237). Vigorous, upright, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, mid- to dark green leaves. Produces deep claret to deep purple flowers, with white throats heavily penciled deep claret, from early summer to fall. Z9–11

P. procerus. Upright, semievergreen perennial. H 20in (50cm), S 8in (20cm). Leaves are oblong to lance-shaped. Bears slim spikes of funnel-shaped, blue-purple flowers in summer. Suitable for a rock garden. Z4–7. **‘Roy Davidson’**, H to 4–6in (10–15cm), is compact, with white-lipped, pink flowers.

P. pulchellus. See *P. campanulatus*.

P. ‘Purple and White’. See *P. ‘Countess of Dalkeith’*.

P. ‘Raven’ (illus. p.237). Strong-growing, erect, semievergreen perennial. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 18–20in (45–50cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, mid- to dark green leaves. Dark purple-red flowers, with white throats penciled faint, dark red in the tubes, coalescing into patches of blackish-purple-red at the lobe bases, are borne freely in summer and fall. Z9–11

P. ‘Red Emperor’. Robust, erect, semi-evergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 18–20in (45–50cm). Has lance-shaped to ovate, mid-green leaves. Produces vivid, bright scarlet flowers, with a golden sheen and white throats streaked and suffused red, in

summer and fall. Z8–10

P. ‘Rich Ruby’. Strong-growing, erect, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Red-purple stems bear lance-shaped to ovate, dark green leaves. From summer to fall, produces large, rich, dark red-purple blooms, with white throats heavily streaked and suffused dark red, coalescing into a dark brown-purple patch at the mouth of each flower tube. Z9–11

P. ‘Royal White’. See *P. ‘White Bedder’*.

P. ‘Rubicundus’ (illus. p.237). Erect, semievergreen perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Leaves are linear and light green. Bears very large, bright red flowers, each with a white throat. Z8–10

P. rupicola. Evergreen, prostrate shrub. H 4in (10cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has rounded to ovate, fleshy, blue-gray leaves. In summer, bears variable, funnel-shaped, pale to deep pink flowers. Best in a rock garden. Z5–9

P. ‘Russian River’ (illus. p.237). Vigorous, stout, erect, semievergreen perennial. H 28in (70cm), S 16in (40cm). Purplish stems bear mid-green, lance-shaped leaves. In summer, produces racemes of tubular, plum-purple flowers, each with a lavender-purple throat lined with darker markings. Z7–9

P. ‘Schoenholzeri’, syn. *P. ‘Firebird’* (illus. p.237). Vigorous, semievergreen, upright perennial. H 2½ft (75cm), S 2ft (60cm). Produces racemes of trumpet-shaped, brilliant scarlet flowers from mid-summer to fall. Lance-shaped to narrowly ovate leaves are mid-green. Z7–10

P. scouleri. See *P. fruticosus* var. *scouleri*.

P. serrulatus, syn. *P. diffusus*, illus. p.341.

P. ‘Six Hills’. Evergreen, prostrate shrub. H 6in (15cm), S 8in (20cm). Has rounded, fleshy, gray-green leaves. In summer, bears funnel-shaped, cool lilac flowers at stem tips. Suitable for a rock garden. Z4–8

P. ‘Snow Storm’. See *P. ‘White Bedder’*.

P. ‘Sour Grapes’ (illus. p.237). Semievergreen perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Light green leaves are narrowly lance-shaped. Bears deep purple-blue flowers suffused violet, from midsummer to early or mid-fall. Z7–10

P. ‘Southgate Gem’. Vigorous, semi-evergreen perennial. H 2½ft (75cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, dark green leaves. Produces an abundance of bright rose-red flowers, with white throats sparsely penciled crimson, in summer and fall. Z7–10

P. ‘Stapleford Gem’ (illus. p.236). Large-leaved, semievergreen perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears large, tubular to bell-shaped, lilac-purple flowers from midsummer to early or mid-fall; upper lips are pale pink-lilac; lower lips and throats are white with purple lines. Leaves are linear to lance-shaped and mid-green. (borderline) Z7–10

P. STROMBOLI (‘Yaboli’) (illus. p.236). Vigorous, semievergreen perennial. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). Produces pale creamy-white flowers, with purplish-pink lobes and faintly purple-pink-streaked, white throats, in summer and fall. Mid-green leaves are lance-shaped to ovate. Z9–11

P. ‘The Juggler’ (illus. p.236). Erect, semievergreen perennial. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 1½–2ft (45–60cm). Produces white-throated, magenta flowers in summer and fall. Z4–9

P. ‘Torquay Gem’. Semievergreen, woody-based perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 12–16in (30–40cm). Has light green, long, lance-shaped leaves. Bears deep rose-red flowers, with a few carmine lines in the white throats, in summer and fall. Z7–10

P. whippleanus (illus. p.237). Erect, semievergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has rounded basal leaves and slender stems bearing lance-shaped, glossy, pale green leaves. In summer, bears clusters of pendent, tubular, dark purple flowers, with cream-marked throats, on the flower spike. Z4–8

P. ‘White Bedder’, syn. *P. ‘Burford White’*, *P. ‘Royal White’*, *P. ‘Snow Storm’* (illus p.236). Semievergreen, free-flowering perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1½ft (45cm). Has white flowers with dark anthers, and linear, fresh green leaves. Z9–11

PENTACHONDRA

ERICACEAE/EPACRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen, spreading shrubs with heathlike leaves. Frost hardy. Needs full light and gritty, moist, peaty soil. Difficult to grow, especially in hot, dry areas. Propagate by rooted offsets in spring, by semiripe cuttings in summer, or by seed in fall.

P. pumila. Evergreen, mat-forming, dense shrub. H 3in (8cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has oblong to narrowly ovate, purplish-green leaves. Small, tubular, white flowers, with reflexed lobes, open in early summer, followed, although rarely in cultivation, by small, spherical, orange fruits. Z9–11

Pentapterygium. See *Agapetes*.

PENTAS

RUBIACEAE

Genus of mainly evergreen perennials, biennials, and shrubs, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Needs full light or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water freely in full growth, moderately at other times. May be hard pruned in winter. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in spring. Prone to whitefly.

P. carnea. See *P. lanceolata*.

P. lanceolata, syn. *P. carnea* (Egyptian star, Star cluster), illus. p.300.

PEPEROMIA

PIPERACEAE

Genus of evergreen, sometimes succulent, perennials, grown for their foliage. Frost tender. Grow in full light or partial shade. Do not overwater. Propagate by division, by seed, or by leaf or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

P. argyreia, syn. *P. sandersii* (Watermelon plant). Evergreen, bushy, compact perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 6in (15cm). Red-stalked, heart-shaped, fleshy, dark green leaves, to 4in (10cm) or more long, are striped with broad bands of silver. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

P. caperata (Emerald ripple) illus. p.465.

P. clusiifolia (Baby rubber plant). Evergreen perennial with branching, sometimes prostrate, reddish-green stems. H to 8in (20cm), S 10in (25cm). Narrowly

ovate, fleshy leaves, 3–6in (8–15cm) long, are dark green, edged with red. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C).

‘Variegata’ has leaves with cream and red margins.

P. dolabriformis (Prayer peperomia). Robust, erect perennial, becoming woody with age. H to 10in (25cm), S 8in (20cm). Has succulent, purse-shaped, bright green leaves, the 2 halves of each leaf folded upward and fused along the dark green margins. Leafy stems bear small spikes of white flowers. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

P. glabella (Wax privet) illus. p.474.

P. griseoargentea, syn. *P. hederifolia* (Ivy-leaf peperomia), illus. p.474.

P. hederifolia. See *P. griseoargentea*.

P. magnoliifolia. See *P. obtusifolia*.

P. metallica. Evergreen perennial with erect, branching, reddish-green stems. H and S to 6in (15cm). Elliptic, dark green leaves, to 1in (2.5cm) long, have a metallic sheen, and wide, pale midribs above, reddish-green veins below. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

P. nummulariifolia. See *P. rotundifolia*.

P. obtusifolia, syn. *P. magnoliifolia* (Pepper face). Evergreen, upright then spreading perennial with leathery, dull green leaves. H and S 10in (25cm). Bears spikes of white flowers. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C).

‘Green and Gold’ has green leaves with golden-yellow margins.

‘Variegata’ illus. p.474.

P. rotundifolia, syn. *P. nummulariifolia* (Creeping buttons). Evergreen, creeping perennial. H 1¼in (3cm), S to 10in (25cm). Very slender stems produce tiny, rounded, fleshy, bright green leaves, 1cm (½in) wide. Flowers are insignificant. Useful for a hanging basket. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

P. rubella. Evergreen perennial with branching, red stems. H to 8in (20cm), S 10in (25cm). Leaves, in whorls of 4 or 5, are around ½in (1cm) long, narrowly ovate, fleshy and pale to dark green above, with paler veins, crimson below. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

P. sandersii. See *P. argyreia*.

P. scandens. Evergreen, climbing or trailing perennial with pinkish-green stems. H to 8in (20cm), S to 20in (50cm). Heart-shaped, fleshy leaves, to 2in (5cm) or more long, are waxy and bright green. Flowers are insignificant. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C)

PERESKIA

CACTACEAE

Genus of deciduous cacti, some of which are climbing, with fleshy leaves and woody stems. Considered the most primitive genus of the Cactaceae, producing true leaves unlike most members of the family. Frost tender. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Water moderately in summer. Propagate by stem cuttings in spring or summer.

P. aculeata (Barbados gooseberry, Lemon vine) illus. p.479. **‘Godseffiana’** (syn. *P.a. var. godseffiana*) is a fast-growing, deciduous, erect, then climbing cactus. H 6–10ft (2–3m), S 3ft (1m). Broadly ovate, slightly fleshy, orange-brown leaves, usually purplish beneath and 3½in (9cm) long, mature to glossy green. Short flower stems, bearing roselike, single, orange-centered, cream flowers, 2in (5cm) across,